time, and deployment proceeded as planned. By the end of 1961, Turkey had fifteen Jupiters that could be launched only by coordinated action of the Turkish and American military—the former operated the missiles, while the latter had control over the nuclear warheads.[5]

John Kennedy never considered the deployment of American missiles in Europe an asset to either American or European security—the Jupiters were perfect targets for the Soviets in case of military confrontation, and it seemed that on October 16 the very fact of their presence had slipped his mind. Shocked by what he considered Khrushchev's reckless deployment of Soviet missiles in Cuba, Kennedy seemed oblivious to any parallel between the Soviet and American missiles. McGeorge Bundy and Deputy Secretary of State Alexis Johnson reminded the president that the US had deployed the nuclear-armed missiles in Turkey. Kennedy still refused to see the parallel between what Khrushchev was doing in Cuba and what the Americans had done in Europe in 1959. "But that was during a different period then," he told his aides. That was exactly the point Johnson was apparently trying to make: Khrushchev, lacking ICBMs of his own, was now in the same position as Eisenhower five years earlier. What for Kennedy was a bygone period of a lack of long-range missiles was present-day reality for Khrushchev.[6]

It was the first day of the crisis, and Kennedy was in a bellicose mood, denying Khrushchev and his actions even a hint of legitimacy. Only on the third day of the crisis, October 18, did Kennedy finally admit the parallel between the Turkish and Cuban situations. In order to predict Khrushchev's next move, he was prepared to put himself in Khrushchev's shoes and suggested to the members of ExCom: "Let's say the situation was reversed, and he had made the statement about these missiles similar to the ones I made about [Cuba]. Similar to the ones about putting our missiles in Turkey. And he had made the statement saying that serious action could result if we put them in, and then we went ahead and put them in. Then he took them out some day." At that point Kennedy was thinking about "taking out" as attacking the missiles rather than removing them. But his thinking on the missiles in Turkey would evolve.[7]

On October 22, the day of his speech on the naval blockade of Cuba, Kennedy had first entertained the idea of trading Soviet missiles in Cuba for